whether you have a suitable version of the SDK installed on your machine by opening a command shell and executing the following command:

```
dotnet --list-sdks
```

You should see one or more versions listed, each with its own installation path. At least one of the versions should begin with *6*. At this stage, if you are a first-time user, you will also need to trust the self-signed certificate that is required for hassle-free browsing of your site over HTTPS on your local system (covered in more detail in chapter 14). To do this, execute the following command:

```
dotnet dev-certs https --trust
```

The certificate itself is installed as part of the SDK installation.

2.1.1 Creating a website using Visual Studio

As described in chapter 1, Visual Studio is the primary IDE for .NET developers working on Windows. It includes simple menu-driven workflows for performing the most common tasks. Razor Pages applications are created as projects within Visual Studio, so your starting point, having opened Visual Studio, is to create a new project. You can do this either by clicking the Create a New Project button on the startup splash screen or going to File > New Project... in the main menu bar.

On the next screen, you can select the type of project you want to create from a list of templates. Before you do, I recommend selecting C# from the languages selector at the top of the right-hand pane to filter out some of the noise. Choose the ASP.NET Core Web App template—the one *without* (Model-View-Controller) as part of its name, taking care also to avoid